

early crop. Midseason and late potatoes can be planted any time between spring and early summer. If you are planting tubers out individually, plant 4–6 in (10–15 cm) deep and cover each with 1 in (2.5 cm) of soil. If planting in rows, dig a shallow trench about 6 in (15 cm) deep, and press tubers into the soil with chits facing upward. Space new potatoes 12 in (30 cm) apart and larger potatoes 15 in (38 cm) apart. Cover with at least 1 in (2.5 cm) of soil. Leave about 24 in (60 cm) space between rows of new potatoes or 30 in (75 cm) between later maturing types.

## **CROP CARE**

Water your potatoes and keep them free from weeds. New types



**Earth up your potatoes as they grow.**

will need watering while they are young; later varieties need less attention until the tubers have started to develop. Applying an organic liquid feed or a top-dressing of fertilizer may help to increase the yield.

Potato plants need “earthing up” as they grow, to ensure that no light reaches the tubers,

## **TIP** GROWING POTATOES IN CONTAINERS

If space is limited or you want to protect new potatoes under cover, plant them in containers or bags.

- Check there are drainage holes; put in 8 in (20 cm) of soil-based compost.
- Place one or two chitted potatoes on top. Cover with about 4 in (10 cm) of compost, and water in well.
- Earth up with compost at intervals and water regularly. Harvest when leaves start to die back.



**Potatoes grow in a variety of containers, such as strong plastic bags, tubs, or pots.**